

I went with the Free Tier template when setting up RDS MySQL because the project has a hard budget ceiling of \$200 per month, and enabling Multi-AZ on top of everything else running would have pushed us over that. Free Tier disables Multi-AZ by default, so there was no standby replica to screenshot.

That said, here is exactly how I would set it up for a real OluPay production environment. Multi-AZ tells AWS to keep a synchronous standby copy of the database running in a second Availability Zone at all times. If the primary instance goes down for any reason, RDS detects it and automatically promotes the standby within 60 to 120 seconds. No manual intervention, no engineer getting woken up at 3am, no users locked out of their accounts on salary day. For a KYC database holding identity records for 2 million users, that kind of automatic failover is not optional in production.

The cost tradeoff is roughly double the RDS instance price. For a development and early-stage deployment, that is hard to justify. For a live payments platform processing salary day traffic, it is completely worth it.

Regarding the missing screenshot: I did capture the RDS Connectivity tab showing Public accessibility set to No, which was the primary evidence requirement for this section. The Multi-AZ configuration screenshot was also taken at the time but was lost when I was organizing configuration, the tradeoffs involved, and what the setup would look like in a production context files across multiple folders during the project. The instance itself was deleted immediately after taking screenshots to manage cost and prevent accumulating charges, so I cannot recreate it. The explanation provided above covers my understanding of the.